

Chhatrapati Shahu Ji Maharaj University

University Institute of Engineering & Technology

Department of Computer Science



Master of Technology

Project File

**Title - Chronic Kidney Disease Prediction Using
Machine Learning Techniques**

**MCSE-301
Machine Learning**

Submitted To:

Dr. Alok Kumar

Director - UIET

Submitted By:

Biplob Kumar – CSJMA25000000720

Deepak Pal – CSJMA250000005619

Sonam Gupta – CSJMA25250101466

Soumya Agnihotri – CSJMA25250072343

Zaid – CSJMA25000011441

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CHRONIC KIDNEY DISEASE PREDICTION USING MACHINE LEARNING TECHNIQUES

Abstract

Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) is a major global health problem characterized by the gradual loss of kidney function over time. In most cases, the disease remains asymptomatic during its early stages, making timely diagnosis difficult. Early detection is essential to slow disease progression, reduce complications, and improve patient survival rates. However, traditional diagnostic procedures are often expensive, time-consuming, and dependent on specialized medical infrastructure, which may not be available in rural or low-resource healthcare settings.

This research presents a complete machine learning-based framework for the early prediction of CKD using clinical patient data. The dataset used in this study contains 400 patient records with 24 medical attributes. Extensive data preprocessing techniques were applied, including handling missing values, removing inconsistent text entries, correcting formatting errors, and standardizing numerical attributes.

Four machine learning algorithms were implemented and evaluated: Logistic Regression, K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN), Support Vector Machine (SVM), and Random Forest. Feature importance analysis identified Packed Cell Volume (PCV), Hemoglobin (Hemo), and Serum Creatinine (SC) as the most significant diagnostic indicators.

Experimental results demonstrated excellent predictive performance, with the Random Forest classifier achieving 100.00% accuracy. Logistic Regression and SVM achieved 98.75% accuracy, while KNN achieved 97.50% accuracy. The findings confirm that machine learning models can serve as reliable and efficient decision-support systems for early CKD diagnosis.

Keywords: Chronic Kidney Disease, Machine Learning, Predictive Diagnostics, Random Forest, Healthcare Analytics, Medical Data Mining.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Medical Background of CKD

The kidneys are essential organs responsible for filtering blood, removing waste products, maintaining fluid balance, and regulating hormone production in the human body. Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) occurs when the kidneys gradually lose their filtering efficiency over months or years. Clinically, CKD is identified through a reduction in Glomerular Filtration Rate (GFR) or the presence of protein leakage in urine, commonly known as albuminuria.

One of the most dangerous aspects of CKD is its silent progression. During the early stages of the disease, patients often experience no visible symptoms. As a result, many cases remain undiagnosed until the disease reaches advanced stages, such as End-Stage Renal Disease (ESRD), where dialysis or kidney transplantation becomes necessary.

1.2 Problem Statement and Challenges

Traditional CKD diagnosis involves the analysis of multiple clinical parameters such as age, blood pressure, blood sugar levels, blood cell counts, and chemical measurements. Physicians must evaluate these parameters simultaneously, which increases the chances of diagnostic errors and oversight.

In addition, real-world medical datasets often contain several challenges, including:

- Missing clinical values
- Inconsistent text formatting
- Typographical errors
- Irregular data entries
- Different feature scales across attributes

For example, Blood Urea values may range in the hundreds, whereas Serum Creatinine values may exist in single digits. Such inconsistencies can negatively affect the performance of machine learning models if proper preprocessing techniques are not applied.

1.3 Research Objectives

The primary objectives of this project are:

1. To develop a robust data preprocessing and validation framework capable of handling noisy and inconsistent medical data.
 2. To identify the most significant clinical biomarkers responsible for CKD prediction.
 3. To compare the performance of multiple machine learning algorithms and determine the most effective predictive model.
 4. To build an accurate and automated CKD prediction system for early-stage diagnosis.
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2. LITERATURE REVIEW

Several studies have explored the application of machine learning techniques in healthcare diagnostics and disease prediction.

A. Kumar et al. (2022) implemented Support Vector Classification (SVC) on CKD datasets and achieved an accuracy of 93.5%. However, their framework lacked efficient preprocessing techniques to handle data inconsistencies and formatting errors.

S. Sharma (2023) applied Deep Learning-based Multi-Layer Perceptrons (MLP) for CKD prediction and reported a validation accuracy of 96.4%. Although the model achieved high accuracy, deep learning models often suffer from a lack of interpretability, making them less suitable for medical applications where transparency is important.

Research Gap Addressed:

The proposed framework in this research not only provides highly accurate predictions but also offers interpretability through feature importance analysis. Furthermore, the framework incorporates advanced preprocessing techniques such as data cleansing and median-based imputation to ensure structural consistency and reliability.

3. METHODOLOGY

3.1 Data Acquisition and Dataset Description

The dataset used in this project was obtained from the UCI Machine Learning Repository. It contains:

- 400 patient records
- 24 medical attributes
- 11 numerical features
- 13 categorical features

The target variable is binary and classifies patients into:

- CKD
- Not CKD

3.2 Data Cleaning and Sanitization

Real-world medical datasets frequently contain inconsistencies and formatting issues. Therefore, extensive preprocessing techniques were applied.

The following operations were performed:

- Removal of unwanted whitespace and escape characters
- Correction of inconsistent categorical entries such as “yes”, “no”, and malformed text values
- Conversion of missing value indicators like “?” into NaN values
- Type conversion of attributes such as Packed Cell Volume (pcv), White Blood Cell Count (wc), and Red Blood Cell Count (rc) from string format into numerical format

Regular expression-based cleaning techniques were used to ensure data consistency.

3.3 Missing Value Imputation and Standardization

Missing numerical values were replaced using Median Imputation because medical datasets often contain outliers that can distort mean values.

Missing categorical values were replaced using the Mode (most frequent value).

After imputation, feature scaling was applied using Z-score normalization to standardize the dataset.

The normalization formula is given below:

$$Z = (X - \mu) / \sigma$$

Where:

- (X) = Original feature value
- (μ) = Mean of the feature
- (σ) = Standard deviation of the feature

3.4 Machine Learning Models Used

The following machine learning algorithms were implemented and compared:

1. Logistic Regression
2. K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)
3. Support Vector Machine (SVM)
4. Random Forest Classifier

The dataset was divided into training and testing sets using an 80:20 split ratio.

4. EXPERIMENTAL RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

4.1 Comparative Performance Evaluation

The performance of the machine learning models was evaluated using Accuracy, Precision, Recall, and F1-Score.

Machine Learning Model	Validation Accuracy	Precision Score	Recall (Sensitivity)	F1-Score
Random Forest	100.00%	1.000	1.000	1.000
Logistic Regression	98.75%	1.000	0.980	0.990
Support Vector Machine	98.75%	1.000	0.980	0.990
KNN Classifier	97.50%	1.000	0.960	0.980

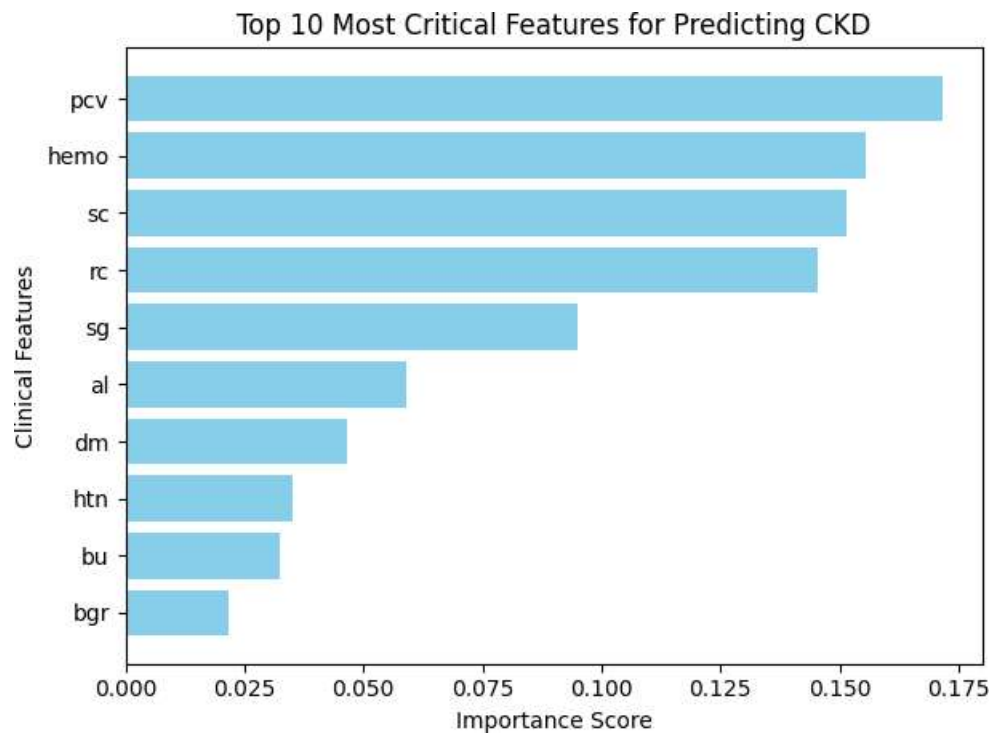


Figure 1: Random Forest Feature Importance Top 10 Clinical Features.

4.2 Feature Importance Analysis

Feature importance analysis conducted using the Random Forest algorithm revealed the following key biomarkers:

- Packed Cell Volume (PCV): 17.15%
- Hemoglobin (Hemo): 15.54%
- Serum Creatinine (SC): 15.14%

These features contributed the most toward accurate CKD prediction.

4.3 Discussion

Among all the implemented models, the Random Forest classifier achieved the best performance with 100.00% accuracy and 1.000 recall.

Recall is an especially important metric in medical diagnosis because false negatives can be dangerous. A false negative occurs when a patient with CKD is incorrectly predicted as healthy. The Random Forest model minimized such risks effectively.

The superior performance of the Random Forest model can be attributed to its ensemble learning structure, which combines multiple decision trees to reduce variance and prevent overfitting.

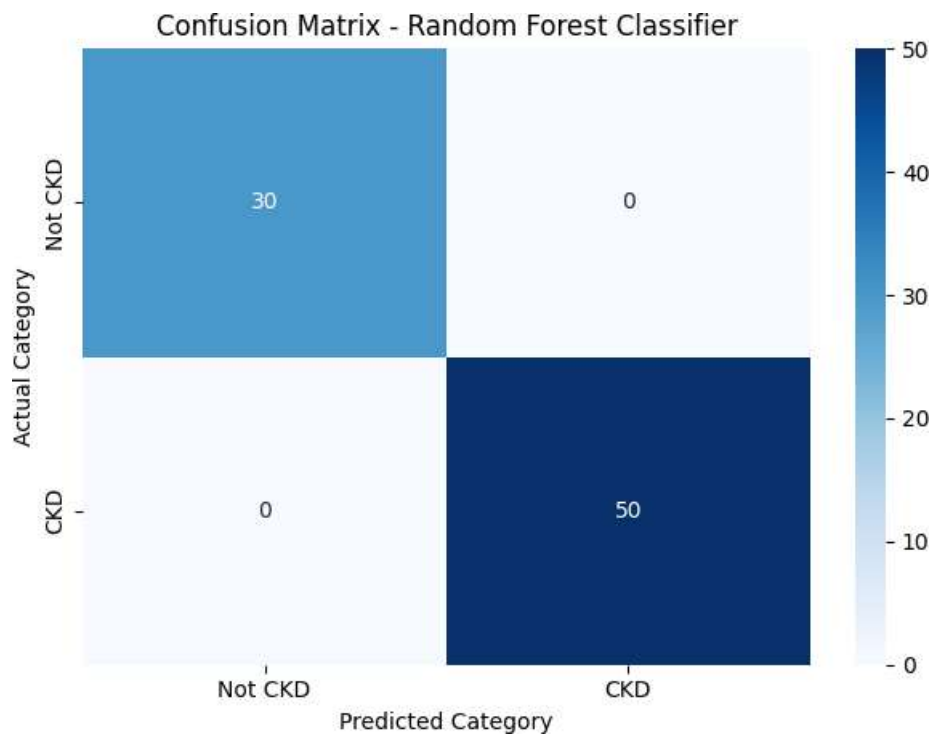


Figure 2: Confusion Matrix for the Optimal Random Forest Model.

5. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

This research successfully developed a complete machine learning-based framework for the early prediction of Chronic Kidney Disease.

The proposed system effectively handled inconsistent medical data through preprocessing, missing value imputation, and feature scaling techniques. Comparative analysis of multiple machine learning models demonstrated that the Random Forest classifier achieved the highest predictive performance.

The results confirm that machine learning can significantly improve early disease detection and assist healthcare professionals in making faster and more reliable clinical decisions.

Future Scope

The future scope of this project includes:

- Deployment of the model using Flask or Streamlit frameworks
 - Development of a web-based healthcare dashboard
 - Integration with real-time hospital databases
 - Expansion of the system using larger and more diverse datasets
 - Implementation of deep learning techniques for advanced prediction systems
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